squash blossoms filled with crab meat

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1. AUG. 2023 • PAID

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Recipe: Makes 10-12 pieces

- 10-12 squash blossoms, pistols removed
- 8 oz crab meat, no shells!
- 1/3 cup mayo
- 1/2 cup chives, sliced
- zest of 1 lemon
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- 3/4 cup all purpose flour
- 1 Tbsp cornstarch
- 1 cup beer
- Oil, for frying

1. Mix crab meat, mayo, chives and lemon zest until all combined.
2. Fill each of the cleaned squash blossoms with the filling. Fill them about 3/4 of the way, and gently pinch the top of the blossms to close them a bit. If you fill them all the way up, the filling could seep out during frying!
3. Heat about 2 inches of canola oil in a large pot for frying. You are looking for the oil to reach around 350 F.
4. While oil heats, in a medium bowl, whisk flour, cornstarch, salt and beer until just combined. A few lumps are ok!
5. Once oil is hot, dip filled squash blossoms, one at a time, to coat. Gently drop in oil and fry until lightly golden, about 3-5 minutes, turning over as needed to fry evenly. Fry in batches so you don't overcrowd the pan.

6. Sprinkle with a touch of salt immediately after frying.
7. Serve hot with chili garlic dipping sauce.

Chili garlic dipping sauce

- 6 thai chiles, stems removed.
- 2 inch piece of ginger, minced
- 5 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tsp chili flakes
- 1/4 cup granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup water
- 1/2 cup rice vinegar
- 1 tsp cornstarch + 1 tsp water, mixed

1. Add chiles, ginger, garlic, chili flakes, sugar, water and vinegar to a medium pot.
2. Bring to boil and drop heat to a simmer. Simmer on low. About 5 minutes.
3. Pour slurry (cornstarch and water) into pot and mix until sauce has thickened. Cook, stirring, for 1 minute.
4. Cool down and serve as dipping sauce.

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